

PEOPLE ARE NOT AWARE OF THE VERSATILITY OF KEYBOARDS



Kulbhushan Seth, presently heading sales and marketing function of Casio India, is one of the key persons who founded Casio in India in 1996 and steered the company to new heights of success in all product categories.

Seth, who is an engineering graduate in electronics & telecommunications with over 20 years of experience, has handled diversified portfolios like R&D, manufacturing, commercial, and marketing & sales. He has been instrumental in taking company to the leadership position in calculators and electronic keyboards categories.

Seth speaks to Uma Bansal of EFY about the latest in keyboards:

■ **KULBHUSHAN SETH**
HEAD-SALES AND MARKETING FUNCTION OF CASIO INDIA

Despite India being a music-loving country, the keyboards aren't popular much here? Is this due to the price or the fact that we shy away from technology?

As a music instrument, keyboards are the second most popular in India. However, presently, people are not aware of the versatility of keyboards. One can play a large number of rhythms and tones today.

What do you suggest for increased adoption?

Awareness about the versatile features of keyboards will definitely increase their adaptation. Like, keyboards can be used in more creative ways: Make your own music by sampling any sound and use it in your own track, play music through the keyboard speakers, etc.

Among acoustic, digital and electronic keyboards, which ones are selling the most and why?

Electronic keyboards are the most popular as these are handy and can be used in many more ways.

What would be a good keyboard for a beginner? What is the price range?

For kids, mini keyboards are suitable. You can get one for Rs 2000 onwards.

What kind do the professionals need? How does it differ from the beginner keyboards?

Professional players' keyboards need to have features like sampling function, registration memory, scale function, rhythm editor, pitch bender, touch response, line-in and line-out jacks, good sound source, arpeggiator, connectivity through SM memory card, USB port and MIDI connectivity.

Does live performance make any difference? What are

the additional requirements?

For performances, line-in and line-out jack, registration memory, rhythm editor, memory card and sampling function are a few of the requisite features.

What does the MIDI do?

Electronic keyboards typically use MIDI signals to send and receive data. MIDI data can also be used to add digital effects (such as reverb, chorus, delay and tremolo) to the sounds played.

How suited are keyboards for Indian music?

Previously, electronic keyboards didn't have Indian tones and rhythms, but two years ago Casio launched Indian keyboard CTK 810in with 15 Indian tones and seven Indian rhythms. Now, this keyboard is extremely successful in India, which itself shows how successful Indian music is in keyboards. Today, Casio has seven keyboards (Indian keyboard and GenNext keyboard) with Indian tones and rhythms.

What and how many Indian tones can the keyboards play?

GenNext CTK 5000 and Indian CTK 810in can play 15 Indian tones (Sitar 1, Sitar 2, Sitar Pad, Tanpura 1, Tanpura 2, Harmonium 1, Harmonium 2, Santur 1, Santur 2, Sarod 1, Sarod 2, Shahnai, Sarangi 1, Sarangi 2, Tabla) and seven Indian rhythms (*bhangra, dadra, garba, keharwa, dandiya, teen taal and bhajan*).

What new features are being added to help one play better?

Using step-up lesson function in keyboards, you can learn keyboard yourself. With audio-in terminal, you can plug-and-play/sing along with the keyboard.